Full text of the *dies irae*

The *dies irae* (the "day of wrath") is a sequence in the Latin funeral mass. A sequence is a piece of music that is chanted before the reading of the gospel (a practice rarely observed today). It is attributed to Thomas of Celano (13th c.). I have bolded the line which I emphasized in the lecture, which is that we are the cause of Jesus' entire earthly life. In Mozart's requiem mass (the *recordare* linked), the *dies irae* is divided over several pieces (*dies irae, tuba mirum, rex tremendae, recordare, confutatis, lacrimosa*), named for the first line of the piece in Latin.

Latin

Text from the Roman Breviary of 1975 (Liturgy of the Hours: According to the Roman Rite, Catholic Book Publishing Co., New York, 1975, vol. IV, pp. 2013-2015).

Dies irae, dies illa
solvet saeclum in favilla,
teste David cum Sibylla.

Quantus tremor est futurus,
quando iudex est venturus
cuncta stricte discussurus!

Tuba mirum spargens sonum
per sepulcra regionum,
coget omnes ante thronum.

Mors stupebit et natura,
cum resurget creatura
iudicanti responsura.

Liber scriptus proferetur,
in quo totum continetur
unde mundus iudicetur.

Iudex ergo cum sedebit,
quicquid latet apparebit;
nil inultum remanebit.

O tu, Deus maiestatis,
alme candor Trinitatis,
nos coniunge cum beatis.

Quid sum miser tunc dicturus,
quem patronum rogaturus,
cum vix iustus sit securus?

English

Translation accessed at: https://www.franciscan-archive.org/de_celano/opera/diesirae.html

Day of wrath, day that
will dissolve the world into burning coals,
as David bore witness with the Sibyl.

How great a tremor is to be,
when the judge is to come
briskly shattering every (grave).

A trumpet sounding an astonishing sound
through the tombs of the region
drives all (men) before the throne.

Death will be stunned and (so) will Nature,
when arises (man) the creature
responding to the One judging.

The written book will be brought forth,
in which the whole (record of evidence) is
contained whence the world is to be judged.

Therefore when the Judge shall sit,
whatever lay hidden will appear;
nothing unavenged will remain.

O Thou, God of Majesty,
nourishing brilliance of the Trinity,
join us with the Blessed.

What am I the wretch then to say?
what patron I to beseech?
when scarcely the just (man) be secure.

Rex tremendae maiestatis,
qui salvandos salvas gratis,
salva me, fons pietatis.

Recordare, Iesu pie,
quid sum causa tuae viae,
ne me perdas illa die.

Quaerens me sedisiti lassus,
redemisti crucem passus;
tantus labor non sit cassus.

Iuste iudex ultionis,
donum fac remissionis
ante diem rationis.

Ingemisco tamquam reus,
culpa rubet vultus meus;
supplicanti parce Deus.

O tu, Deus maiestatis,
alme candor Trinitatis,
nos coniunge cum beatis.

Peccatricem qui solvisit
et latronem exaudisti,
mihi quoque spem dedisti.

Preces meae non sunt dignae,
sed tu, bonus, fac benigne
ne perenni cremer igne.

Inter oves locum praesta
et ab haedis me sequestra,
statuens in parte dextra.

Confutatis maledictis,
flammis acribus addictis,
voca me cum benedictis.

Oro supplex et acclinis,
cor contritum quasi cinis,
gere curam mei finis.

Lacrimosa dies illa,
qua resurget ex favilla

King of tremendous Majesty,
who saves those-to-be-saved free,
save me, Fount of piety.

Remember, faithful Jesus,
because I am the cause of your journey:
do not lose me on that day.

Thou has sat down as one wearied seeking me,
Thou has redeemed (me) having suffered the
Cross:
so much labor let it not be lost.

Just judge of the avenging-punishment,
work the gift of the remission (of sins)
before the Day of the Reckoning.

I groan, as the accused:
my face grows red from (my) fault:
spare (this) supplicant, O God.

O Thou, God of Majesty,
nourishing brilliance of the Trinity,
join us with the Blessed.

Thou who forgave Mary [the sinful woman],
and favorably heard the (good) thief,
hast also given me hope.

My prayers are not worthy,
but do Thou, Good (God), deal kindly
lest I burn in perennial fire.

Among the sheep offer (me) a place
and from the goats sequester me,
placing (me) at (Thy) right hand.

After the accursed have been silenced,
given up to the bitter flames,
call me with the blest.

Kneeling and bowed down I pray,
My heart contrite as ashes:
Do Thou {, my End,} care for my end.

That sorrowful day,
on which will arise from the burning coals

iudicandus homo reus:
huic ergo parce, Deus.

Man accused to be judged:
therefore, O God, do Thou spare him.